

HEALING FOR THE HOMES SERIES

GOD, I'M LOCKED DOWN

He sent His word
and healed them,
and delivered them
from their destructions.

— PSALM 107:20



Overcomers
Global Network

EDUCATE . EQUIP . EVOLVE

BY PROPHET JOSHUA MATTHEWS

DEDICATION

This booklet is dedicated to every soul who feels trapped — trapped by circumstances, trapped by mental bondage, trapped by fear, trapped by a season that will not end. Whether your prison is physical, emotional, or spiritual, the God who breaks chains is about to visit your cell. Hold on.

The door is opening.

A MESSAGE FROM THE FOUNDER

Dear friend,

I know what it is like to feel locked down — when your body is free but your spirit is in chains. When the walls around you are not made of concrete but of anxiety, depression, past trauma, financial pressure, and spiritual warfare. I have ministered to people in literal prison cells who had more freedom in their spirit than some believers sitting in comfortable homes.

Being locked down is not always about your location. It is about your condition. And the good news — the Gospel truth — is that Jesus Christ came specifically for prisoners. Not just the ones behind bars. The ones behind invisible walls.

This booklet is your key. Not because of anything I have written, but because the Word of God is alive and powerful, and when it enters your situation, chains break. Read expectantly. Your breakthrough is in these pages.

With all my love in Christ,

Joshua Matthews

Founder, Overcomers Global Network

The Cry of the Soul

You wake up every morning and the first thing you feel is the weight. It is not a physical weight — nothing you can point to, nothing you can explain to someone over coffee. But it is there. Pressing. Constant. Like invisible hands holding you down.

You try to pray, and the words won't come. You try to plan for the future, and your mind goes blank — or worse, it spirals into fear. You try to do the basic things — work, parent, eat, sleep — and every task feels like walking through water. Heavy. Slow. Exhausting.

People around you say things like, "Just trust God" or "This too shall pass," and you want to scream because they do not understand. You *are* trusting God. You *know* it will pass. But right now, in this moment, you feel locked down — and no amount of positive thinking is opening the door.

Maybe your lockdown is financial — bills stacking up, no job in sight, every door you knock on stays shut. Maybe it is relational — stuck in a toxic environment you cannot leave, or trapped in loneliness so deep you've forgotten what genuine connection feels like. Maybe it is mental — anxiety that grips you from the moment you open your eyes, depression that turns every color gray, thoughts that loop and loop and never resolve.

Maybe it is spiritual — a season where heaven feels sealed and you cannot break through no matter how hard you worship, pray, or fast. Like there is a glass ceiling between you and God.

"God, I'm locked down. I can't move. I can't breathe. When does this end?"

Hear me clearly: God heard that prayer. And He is answering it through the words on this page.

What the Bible Says

The Bible is filled with stories of people who found themselves locked down — and every single one of them was delivered. Let me show you.

""But at midnight Paul and Silas were praying and singing hymns to God, and the prisoners were listening to them. Suddenly there was a great earthquake, so that the foundations of the prison were shaken; and immediately all the doors were opened and everyone's chains were loosed.""

— Acts 16:25–26 (NKJV)

Paul and Silas were in a literal prison cell. They had been beaten, stripped, and locked in the innermost cell with their feet fastened in stocks. By every natural measurement, they were done. No lawyer. No bail. No hope.

But notice what they did at midnight — the darkest hour. They did not complain. They did not negotiate. They *worshipped*. They prayed and sang hymns to God while still bleeding, still chained, still locked down.

And God responded with an earthquake. Not a small tremor — a shaking so violent that the foundations of the prison cracked, every door flew open, and every chain fell off. Not just theirs. *Everyone's*.

Here is what the Holy Spirit wants you to understand: your praise in the prison is the key to the earthquake. When you worship God in the middle of your lockdown — not because you feel like it, but because you choose to — something shakes in the spiritual realm. The foundations of your bondage begin to crack. And what has held you begins to lose its grip.

""The Lord is near to those who have a broken heart, and saves such as have a contrite spirit. Many are the afflictions of the righteous, but the Lord delivers him out of them all.""

— Psalm 34:18–19 (NKJV)

Consider Joseph. This was a young man who had a dream from God — and everything that followed seemed designed to destroy it. His brothers threw him in a pit, sold him into slavery, and told their father he was dead. He was falsely accused of assault by Potiphar's wife and thrown into prison,

where he sat for *years* — forgotten, overlooked, locked down.

But here is the secret of Joseph's story: the prison was not the end. It was the preparation. Every year in that cell, God was building something in Joseph that a palace could not produce. He was developing patience, wisdom, humility, and intimacy with God that would sustain him when he became second in command of Egypt.

""But the Lord was with Joseph and showed him mercy, and He gave him favor in the sight of the keeper of the prison.""

— **Genesis 39:21 (NKJV)**

Even in the prison, God was *with* Joseph. Even in the lockdown, Joseph had *favor*. Your location does not determine God's location. He is with you in the cell, and He is working in the cell, and He is preparing something through the cell that you cannot see yet.

Jeremiah the prophet was also imprisoned — thrown into a muddy cistern and left to die (Jeremiah 38:6). Daniel was thrown into a lions' den (Daniel 6). The three Hebrew boys were thrown into a furnace (Daniel 3). And in every case — *every single case* — God showed up in the place of lockdown and turned it into a place of testimony.

The furnace did not kill the three Hebrew boys. It burned off their ropes. The things that bound them were consumed, but they walked out without even the smell of smoke on their clothes (Daniel 3:27). Child of God, your fire is not going to destroy you. It is going to burn off everything that has been holding you back.

The Root of the Pain

Fear. Fear is one of the most common locks on the soul. It paralyzes decision-making, distorts reality, and keeps you frozen in place. Fear whispers, "If you move, something bad will happen. Stay where you are. Don't try. Don't hope. Don't risk."

Neurologically, fear activates the amygdala — the brain's alarm system — which triggers a "fight, flight, or freeze" response. When fear becomes chronic, the brain remains in a constant state of alert, draining your energy, disrupting sleep, and making it nearly impossible to think clearly or feel peace. This is why anxiety is so physically exhausting — your body is in survival mode 24 hours a day.

""For God has not given us a spirit of fear, but of power and of love and of a sound mind.""

— 2 Timothy 1:7 (NKJV)

If God did not give you that fear, then someone else did. And what the enemy gives, God has the authority to remove.

Hopelessness. When you have been in lockdown long enough, you stop expecting it to end. Psychologists call this "learned helplessness" — a state where a person has been so conditioned by painful circumstances that they stop trying to escape, even when the door is open.

In a landmark study, researchers found that animals exposed to inescapable stress eventually stopped trying to avoid pain, even when they were later given a clear way out. Their brains had been trained to believe that nothing they did would change their situation. This same pattern occurs in humans who endure prolonged emotional, financial, or spiritual lockdown.

But God's Word shatters learned helplessness:

""With God all things are possible.""

— Matthew 19:26 (NKJV)

Isolation. Lockdown often comes with isolation — and isolation is one of the enemy's most effective weapons. When you are alone with your thoughts, every lie gets louder. Every fear gets bigger. Every problem gets heavier. God designed you for community, and the enemy knows that if he can separate you from the body of Christ, he can pick you off.

""Two are better than one, because they have a good reward for their labor. For if they fall, one will lift up his companion. But woe to him who is alone when he falls, for he has no one to help him up.""

— Ecclesiastes 4:9–10 (NKJV)

Spiritual Warfare. Make no mistake — some lockdowns are not natural. They are orchestrated by the enemy to keep you from your destiny. Daniel experienced this. He prayed and fasted for 21 days and heard nothing. Then an angel appeared and said:

""Do not fear, Daniel, for from the first day that you set your heart to understand, and to humble yourself before your God, your words were heard; and I have come because of your words. But the prince of the kingdom of Persia withstood me twenty-one days.""

— Daniel 10:12–13 (NKJV)

Daniel's prayer was heard on day one. The answer was dispatched immediately. But there was spiritual resistance that delayed the breakthrough for 21 days. Your answer may already be on the way. The delay is not denial. The silence is not absence. There is a battle happening in the spiritual realm over your freedom, and heaven is winning.

Do not stop praying. Do not stop worshipping. Your midnight praise is shaking the foundations of your prison right now.

Christ's Healing Power

When Jesus began His public ministry, the very first thing He declared was freedom for the imprisoned:

""The Spirit of the Lord is upon Me, because He has anointed Me to preach the gospel to the poor; He has sent Me to heal the brokenhearted, to proclaim liberty to the captives and recovery of sight to the blind, to set at liberty those who are oppressed.""

— Luke 4:18 (NKJV)

Liberty to the captives. Freedom for the oppressed. This is not a metaphor — this is His mission statement. This is what He came to do. And He has not stopped doing it.

Jesus also said:

""Therefore if the Son makes you free, you shall be free indeed.""

— **John 8:36 (NKJV)**

The word "indeed" is the Greek word *ontōs* — it means truly, really, in actual fact. Jesus is not offering you metaphorical freedom or partial freedom. He is offering you real, complete, actual freedom. Freedom in your mind. Freedom in your emotions. Freedom in your circumstances. Freedom in your spirit.

Right now, I feel the Spirit of the Lord moving as I write these words. He is saying to someone reading this: "Your lockdown ends today. Not tomorrow. Not next month. Today. The chains are already broken — you just need to stand up and walk out."

Maybe you have been sitting in an open cell. Maybe the door was unlocked months ago, but you were so conditioned by the darkness that you forgot to check. Check the door, beloved. Push on it. It's open. Christ opened it with His blood, and no devil in hell can close it again.

Healing Prayers

A Prayer for Freedom from Mental Lockdown

Father, I come to You in the name of Jesus Christ. My mind has been a prison. Thoughts of fear, anxiety, hopelessness, and confusion have circled me like walls I cannot climb. But Your Word says You have given me a spirit of power, love, and a sound mind. I claim that promise now. I rebuke every lying thought that contradicts Your truth. I cast down every imagination that exalts itself above the knowledge of God (2 Corinthians 10:5). Free my mind, Lord. Let peace flood my thoughts. Let clarity replace confusion. Let hope replace despair. Renew my mind according to Your

Word (Romans 12:2). In Jesus' name, amen.

A Prayer for Breakthrough in Your Circumstances

Lord God, You are the door opener that no man can shut (Revelation 3:8). I bring my locked-down situation before You — my finances, my health, my relationships, my career, my ministry. Where doors have been closed, fling them open by Your power. Where walls have been built, tear them down like Jericho. Where the enemy has set up blockades, send Your angels to clear the way. I trust You, Lord. I may not see the path, but I believe You are making one. Lead me out. In Jesus' mighty name, amen.

A Prayer for Strength to Endure

Holy Spirit, give me strength for today. I do not need to see the whole road — I just need enough grace for this moment. Hold me up when my knees buckle. Speak to me when the silence is deafening. Remind me that this season has an expiration date and that joy comes in the morning (Psalm 30:5). I will not give up. I will not quit. I will worship You in this cell until the earthquake comes. In Jesus' name, amen.

Prophetic Declarations

"My lockdown is over. I am walking out of this season free."

"No chain can hold what God has set free."

"I am not stuck. God is making a way where there is no way."

"Fear has no authority over my life. I serve the God of power."

"My midnight praise is shaking the foundations of my prison."

"What the enemy meant for my destruction, God is using for my promotion."

"Like Joseph, my prison is my preparation. My purpose is still alive."

"The fire will not consume me. It will only burn off my chains."

"I will not die in this place. I will live to declare the works of the Lord."

"The Lord is with me. He has never left. He is working even now."

Reflection & Healing

Reflect on These Questions

1. What does your lockdown look like? Is it mental, emotional, spiritual, financial, relational — or all of the above?
2. When did this season begin? Can you identify what triggered it?
3. What lies have you believed about your situation? ("This will never end." "God doesn't care." "I'm stuck forever.")
4. Which biblical story of deliverance speaks to you the most — Paul and Silas, Joseph, Daniel, or the three Hebrew boys? Why?
5. What is your midnight praise? What can you worship God for right now, even in the middle of your lockdown?
6. What is one step of faith you can take this week to push against the walls of your prison?

Your lockdown is temporary. Your God is eternal. The door is opening. Walk through it.

A CLOSING PRAYER

Father, in the name of Jesus Christ, I stand in agreement with this reader and I declare: FREEDOM. I speak to every chain — seen and unseen — and I say break, in Jesus' name. I speak to every prison door — emotional, spiritual, mental, physical — and I say open, in Jesus' name.

Lord, let the anointing of the Holy Spirit fall on them right now like it fell in the jail cell with Paul and Silas. Shake the foundations of their bondage. Loose their bands. Open every door.

I decree they will walk out of this season a free person. They will never be locked down again. The Son has set them free, and they are free indeed. In Jesus' mighty name, amen.

AN INVITATION TO CHRIST

If you have never made Jesus your Lord, or if you have been away from Him, this is your jailbreak moment. Pray: "Jesus, I am locked down and I need You. I confess my sin and I surrender my life to You. You are my deliverer, my chain-breaker, my Savior. I receive You now. Fill me with Your Spirit. Set me free. In Your name, amen."

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Some prisons cannot be seen with the natural eye. This booklet is for the person who feels trapped by fear, pressure, heaviness, or invisible chains. Through the Word of God, healing insight, and strong prayer, Joshua Matthews reveals that Christ still breaks bondages and opens closed doors.

The God who opens
prison doors can open yours.



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